ATHX PREP

FREE ATHX TRAINING WEEK

A week taken from the ATHX PREP program: 4 full-body strength sessions with SkiErg and rower finishers, and one ATHX Metcon session.

Aubin Patrix · 1st in the Strength zone at ATHX Paris 2026
en.preparation-athx.fr

How to use it

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	SESSION
Monday	Full body 1 + SkiErg
Tuesday	Full body 2 + rower
Wednesday	Rest
Thursday	Full body 3 + SkiErg / rower EMOM
Friday	Full body 4 + rower / SkiErg
Saturday	ATHX Metcon
Sunday	Rest

READING THE INTENSITY

- **RPE**: perceived difficulty out of 10. RPE 8 = about 2 reps in reserve; RPE 10 = failure.
- **% of 1RM**: a percentage of your maximum load. Estimate your maxes at en.preparation-athx.fr/1rm-calculator, then round to 2.5 kg.
- **Warm-up**: the number of ramp-up sets before the working sets.
- **Top set**: a single heavy set, followed by lighter sets.

Your starting maxes (fill in)

Squat 1RM: _____ kg	**Deadlift** 1RM: _____ kg	**Bench press** 1RM: _____ kg
Overhead press 1RM: _____ kg	**Bodyweight** _____ kg	**Target category** Lite / ATHX / Pro

* Indicative percentages: adjust them to how you feel and to the target RPE. If you have pain or any doubt about your health, see a professional before training heavy.

Session 1 · Monday

SQUAT AND OVERHEAD PRESS

General warm-up: 8 to 10 min of easy rowing or SkiErg, then hip and shoulder mobility.

EXERCISE	WARM-UP	SETS × REPS	INTENSITY	REST	CUE
Back squat (top set)	4	1 × 5	RPE 7.5	3-4 min	Controlled tempo, explosive drive
Back squat	—	2 × 8	≈ 70%*	3-4 min	Same back angle on every rep
Overhead press	2	3 × 8	≈ 70%*	2-3 min	Start from a dead stop on each rep
Glute ham raise	1	3 × 8-10	RPE 7	1-2 min	Keep the hips aligned
Helms row	1	3 × 12-15	RPE 9	1-2 min	Strict form, elbows back at 45°
Hammer curl	—	3 × 20-25	RPE 10	1-2 min	Elbows fixed, squeeze the handle hard

SkiErg finisher

5 × 250 m, 1 min rest.

Solid, steady pace: all 5 blocks in the same time.

NOTES

Session 2 · Tuesday

DEADLIFT AND BENCH PRESS

General warm-up: 8 to 10 min of easy rowing or SkiErg, then hip and shoulder mobility.

EXERCISE	WARM-UP	SETS × REPS	INTENSITY	REST	CUE
Deadlift	4	3 × 6	≈ 75%*	3-5 min	Conventional or sumo
Bench press (top set)	4	1 × 3	RPE 8.5	4-5 min	Hard set: keep 1 to 2 reps in reserve
Pause bench press	—	2 × 10	≈ 67%*	2-3 min	1 s pause on the chest
Hip abduction	—	3 × 15-20	RPE 9	1-2 min	Machine or band, 1 s hold at the top
Weighted pull-ups	1	3 × 5-8	RPE 8	3-4 min	Grip 1.5 × shoulder width, chest to the bar
Standing calf raises	1	3 × 8-10	RPE 9	2-3 min	1/2 s pause at the bottom of each rep

Rower finisher

4 × 300 m, 1 min rest.

Leg drive first, 26-30 strokes/min.

NOTES

Session 3 · Thursday

SQUAT AND DIPS

General warm-up: 8 to 10 min of easy rowing or SkiErg, then hip and shoulder mobility.

EXERCISE	WARM-UP	SETS × REPS	INTENSITY	REST	CUE
Back squat	4	3 × 4	≈ 80%*	3-4 min	Keep your upper back pressed into the bar
Weighted dips	2	3 × 8	RPE 8	2-3 min	Full range of motion, shoulders down
Hanging leg raises	—	3 × 10-12	RPE 9	1-2 min	Knees to chest, controlled; straight legs to make it harder
Pull-over	1	3 × 12-15	RPE 8	1-2 min	Dumbbell, rope or band: stretch and squeeze the lats
Incline dumbbell curl	1	3 × 12-15	RPE 9	1-2 min	One arm at a time, start with the weaker arm
Face pull	—	4 × 15-20	RPE 9	1-2 min	Squeeze the shoulder blades as you pull

SkiErg + rower finisher

10-min EMOM: odd minutes 12 / 10 cal SkiErg, even minutes 12 / 10 cal rower (M / W).

If you can't keep up with the minute, take off 2 calories.

NOTES

Session 4 · Friday

PAUSE DEADLIFT AND PAUSE BENCH PRESS

General warm-up: 8 to 10 min of easy rowing or SkiErg, then hip and shoulder mobility.

EXERCISE	WARM-UP	SETS × REPS	INTENSITY	REST	CUE
Pause deadlift	4	4 × 2	≈ 75%*	3-4 min	2 s pause just below the knees
Pause bench press	3	3 × 5	≈ 75%*	2-3 min	Clear pause on the chest, then explode
Chest-supported T-bar row or Pendlay row	1	3 × 10	RPE 7	2-3 min	Pull with your back, not your arms
Nordic ham curl (or leg curl)	—	3 × 6-8	RPE 8	1-2 min	Lower as slowly as possible
Dumbbell shrug	—	3 × 20-25	RPE 9	1-2 min	Stretch at the bottom, squeeze hard at the top

Rower + SkiErg finisher

3 rounds: 250 m rower + 250 m SkiErg, 2 min rest.

Race pace: the transition must be fast.

NOTES

Session 5 · Saturday

ATHX METCON

A session to prepare for the Endurance zone and Metcon X sequence. Use the loads for your category, or slightly lighter if your technique breaks down.

Warm-up
10 min easy rowing + hip and shoulder mobility

Block 1: run + SkiErg
2 × (1 km run + 500 m SkiErg), 3 min rest. Solid but controlled pace, like in the Endurance zone.

Block 2: mini Metcon X
3 rounds at moderate intensity, 3 min rest between rounds: 15 / 12 cal rower, 10 dumbbell ground-to-overhead, 12 dumbbell bench presses, 10 sandbag squats, 30 m sandbag carry, 8 burpees over a bench.

Cool-down
5 min walking or very easy rowing, stretching

2027 Metcon X loads by category and technique for each movement: en.preparation-athx.fr/athx-2027-workouts/metcon-x

ATHX PREP

AND AFTER WEEK 1?

Over 12 weeks, the program alternates full-body weeks and upper / lower weeks, progresses the loads and RPEs, varies the exercises and includes a deload before the competition. **Every load is calculated from your PRs.** The full program is written in French.

Get the full program · €14.99

Free guides: ATHX 2027 workouts, categories, movements and training by city (Paris, Montpellier, Marseille) at en.preparation-athx.fr

Newsletter: one email a week with sessions and tips. Unsubscribe in one click.